



Rich Lesser

Global Chair (CEO 2013–2021)

1963

Founded

33,500

Employees

\$14.4B

2025 revenue

25%

Revenue from AI

40%+

AI & tech services

01 Who You're Meeting

Rich Lesser — Global Chair (CEO 2013–2021), Boston Consulting Group.

In role: Global Chair since 2021, having been CEO from 2013 to 2021

Today: Engages CEOs, boards and senior leaders worldwide on climate and sustainability, resilience and purpose, rather than running the firm day to day.

An engineer who became one of consulting's most visible figures on climate. He started at Procter & Gamble as a product development engineer and group leader, joined BCG in 1988, ran the New York Metro office system from 2000 to 2009 and was BCG's chairman for North and South America from 2009 to 2012. Elected CEO in 2012 and serving from 2013 to 2021, he oversaw a period of exceptional growth and launched the structures BCG's current AI business rests on — BCG Digital Ventures, BCG GAMMA (advanced analytics and machine learning), BCG TURN and the BCG Center for Climate &

Career: Global Chair, Boston Consulting Group; Chief Executive Officer, Boston Consulting Group; Chairman, North and South America, Boston Consulting Group; Head of the New York Metro office system, Boston Consulting Group

Education: MBA, Harvard Business School (Baker Scholar); BSE Chemical Engineering with highest honors, University of Michigan

The company: \$14.4B of 2025 revenue across 33,500 people, with AI and technology services now over 40% of the total and AI-specific work at 25% — roughly \$3.6B. It is the first of the strategy firms to publish that figure, which makes it the benchmark the others get measured against.

What they sell: Strategy and transformation consulting, paired with BCG X — an in-house build arm that develops bespoke AI solutions and deploys industry platforms such as Auto AI, Retail AI and Deep Customer Engagement AI directly into client systems. The BCG X AI Science Institute launched in 2025.

02 Where The Company Sits

BCG's distinguishing move is structural, not rhetorical: BCG X means it builds and deploys into client systems rather than handing over a recommendation, which puts it in genuine overlap with systems integrators on delivery while retaining strategy-firm pricing. Its stated 10-20-70 allocation — 10% algorithms, 20% technology and data, 70% people and process — is a useful framing for anyone planning portfolio AI adoption, and matches the reference model's emphasis on adoption and change over model selection.

03 Talking Points

- Climate and sustainability are his genuine specialism, which matters for energy-transition and decarbonisation questions across the portfolio.
- He built the AI and digital units BCG now sells; a credible reference on whether BCG X is real capability or repackaging.
- Chair, not CEO — Schweizer runs the firm. Use Lesser for strategic or climate-led conversations.

What to pressure-test about the company:

- Growth slowed to 7% in 2025 from 10% in 2024, while AI revenue grew 25% — implying the non-AI business is close to flat
- Headcount grew only 500 in a year in which AI revenue grew 25%, which raises a question about delivery capacity or leverage
- Published AI platforms are automotive, retail and customer engagement — no infrastructure-sector platform is disclosed

04 GIP Context

GIP: No publicly disclosed GIP relationship. BCG's published AI platform portfolio skews to consumer-facing sectors, so relevance to energy, transport, digital and water assets would need to be tested rather than assumed.

BlackRock: None publicly disclosed.

Others at Boston Consulting Group: Christoph Schweizer (Chief Executive Officer)

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